

Industry News

3G to drive smartphone sales in India

India has witnessed the highest growth rate of mobile subscribers, registering 49 per cent in the period 2009-10. And with the advent of 3G, the telecom industry and mobile services are only expected to see an upsurge. The 3G/BWA spectrum and the advent of WiMAX and LTE-based 4G technologies will play a crucial role in shaping up the broadband industry in India. The Indian mobile market is still voice-intensive and the operators' major source of revenue. In this context, voice-based 3G services will see greater acceptance.

According to a Frost & Sullivan report, "Introduction of 3G/BWA has opened up a huge market for equipment vendors, content providers and smartphone providers. Smartphones are changing consumer behaviour like never before by enabling consumers to access the Internet via mobile devices. The smartphones volume for CY 2009 was 2.4 million units, and is expected to grow at a CAGR of 39.2 per cent for the period FY 2010-16. The success of the smartphone as a consumer device has fundamentally improved the ease of use and access of 3G services."

Net-connected TV sales grow 125 per cent globally

Worldwide, Internet-connected TVs are selling more than the much touted 3-D technology. As many as 28 million TV sets with built-in Internet connectivity are expected to ship in 2010, according to market research firm iSuppli, compared to just 4 million 3-D TVs. This would be a rise of 125 per cent on the 12 million units shipped last year.

Going by the competition between TV makers to offer Web services and content such as movies, music and

New leaders at MAIT

Manufacturers' Association for Information Technology (MAIT) has appointed Ashwini Aggarwal as its new executive director. Aggarwal has replaced Vinnie Mehta, who recently joined Automotive Component Manufacturers' Association (ACMA). He comes to MAIT with over 27 years of industry experience, including 18 years at Hewlett-Packard in several important and developmental roles. More recently, he worked with Omnicom Media, in their group company CPM India as vice-president, strategic initiatives.

Sandeep Nair, president, Emerson Network Power (India), has taken over as the new MAIT president and Alok Bharadwaj, senior vice president, Canon India, as vice president for the term 2010-11.

IPCA elects president

At its annual general body meeting held recently, India Printed Circuit Association (IPCA) elected Mukund Shah of Genus Electrotech as president for the biennium 2010-12.

IPCA is a professional organisation of designers, PCB manufacturers, assemblers and allied industries. It is also a member of World Electronic Circuits Council.

Doshi is co-chair of USIBC Solar Power Task Force

Aparna Doshi, chief operating officer of Astonfield Renewable Resources, has been named co-chair of the US India

photos, market research firm iSuppli expects that by 2014, around 54 per cent of flat-panel TVs shipped—about 148 million units—will have Internet connectivity and services.

Netbook shipments to soar 30 per cent

Netbook shipments will increase 30 per cent this year, leading the overall PC

In Focus

Business Council (USIBC) Solar Power Task Force—a major initiative to promote US-India trade and investment in the burgeoning solar power sector.

As the subcommittee of USIBC's Energy, Environment, Enterprise (EEE) Executive Committee, comprising more than 100 members, the USIBC Solar Task Force will be pivotal in the development of clean energy in India and beyond.

Alcatel-Lucent appoints VP India

Alcatel-Lucent has appointed Sardeep Garg as vice president-services, India. Based in Gurgaon, Garg will report to Vivek Mohan, president of Alcatel-Lucent's services activities. In this role, he will be responsible for driving excellence in the services organisation including managed services and network systems integration. He will lead a team working towards providing best-in-class service delivery, quality and innovative support to the company's customers in India. He will also liaise with customer-facing teams to develop and execute products and solutions for emerging markets.

Texecom appoints new business manager for India

UK-based intruder alarm manufacturer Texecom has appointed a new business development manager to support its sales in India. Munish Dudgeja joins Texecom from Honeywell, with which he has gained many years of experience working in the intruder alarm industry. Reporting directly to Peter Harries, Texecom's global sales director, Dudgeja will take control of the company's business operations in India.

industry growth on strong consumer demand, according to iSuppli.

Taiwan's Acer, which last year overtook rivals to become the world's No. 2 PC company, will probably keep its position as the No. 1 netbook supplier this year.

Netbook shipments will increase this year to 34.5 million units and nearly double to 58.3 million units by 2014,